



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Brookfield School

School Website: <https://brookfieldprivateschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit Report: Austin Classical School**

Website audited: <https://austinclassical.org>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The school explicitly or implicitly matches the Six Essential Elements framework across mission, curriculum (Trivium, Latin, logic, rhetoric, Great Books), pedagogy (memorization, recitation, songs and chants; debate/discussion; senior thesis/orations), Christian theological grounding (mission to glorify Jesus Christ; Christian Studies sequence; chapel), and a strong parent partnership model (co-teacher parents in a collaborative schedule). The presence of ACCS accreditation further corroborates classical Christian alignment. Evidence includes frequent use of terms such as truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; Trivium; Latin; rhetoric; chanting; chapel; and explicit statements about formation over utilitarian, career-prep aims (e.g., “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about...eternal purpose”). - Most important insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit, Christ-centered, and practiced communally (All-School chapel noted in tour schedule; Christian Studies from doctrine to apologetics). - Purpose centers on cultivating wisdom and virtue through contemplation of the true, good, and beautiful—aligned with classical moral realism and formation (not mere information). - Curriculum explicitly names the Trivium, Latin, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, and integrated knowledge—all core positive indicators in the Six Elements lexicon. - Pedagogy shows grammar-stage memory work with “songs and chants,” logic-stage debate/discussion, and rhetoric-stage thesis and oratory—precisely the practices the framework calls out. - Parents and community are central due to the collaborative model with “co-teacher parents,” a hallmark of classical parent partnership. - Reference framework used: Six Essential Elements positive/negative keyword indicators for all six categories (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community) and the consolidated classicality lexicon.

Method and Keyword Analysis (per Six Elements) For each category: 1) Keywords found on the school site 2) Match against Six Elements positive/negative lists 3) Quantitative estimate of positive vs negative hits 4) Category rating

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS 1) School keywords found: - “glorify Jesus Christ”; “classical, Christian education”; “truth, goodness, and beauty”; “All School chapel”; “Christian Studies” sequence (Development of Christian Doctrine, Exegesis/Hermeneutics, Apologetics & Ethics). 2) Comparison to Six Elements: - Positive indicators matched: truth, goodness, beauty; theology/biblical studies; worship/chapel (liturgical/communal practice). These terms align with moral realism and theology grounding in the framework. - No negative indicators (e.g., values-neutral, secular/faith-optional framing) observed. 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive keyword instances: 10+ (e.g., Jesus Christ; Christian; truth/goodness/beauty; chapel; doctrine; apologetics) vs Negative: 0. Estimated percent_positive ~1.00; coverage ~0.95. 4) Score: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL 1) School keywords found: - “cultivate wisdom and virtue”; “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”; “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose”. 2) Comparison to Six Elements: - Positive indicators matched: cultivation of wisdom/virtue; pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty; formation over information (explicitly de-emphasizes career prep). - No negative signals (e.g., “college and career readiness” as the main purpose) present. 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 8+; Negative hits: 0. Estimated

percent_positive ~1.00; coverage ~0.95. 4) Score: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM 1) School keywords found: - Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric); Latin (5th–8th); formal logic (8th); rhetoric (10th+); Great Books/great ideas/great conversation; integrated knowledge; robust Upper School course grid (Ancient/Medieval/Modern lit & history; exegesis/hermeneutics; apologetics/ethics; rhetoric; senior thesis). 2) Comparison to Six Elements: - Positive indicators matched: Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium named explicitly; Quadrivium partly via geometry/music in fine arts program); Great Books/primary texts claim; interdisciplinary integration emphasized (“interrelation of all knowledge”). - No negative indicators like “Social Studies” displacing “History” or STEM-first marketing; “History” is used robustly (Ancient, Medieval & Renaissance, U.S.). 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 12+ (Trivium, Latin, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, integrated) vs Negative: 0. Estimated percent_positive ~1.00; coverage ~0.95. 4) Score: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY / TEACHING METHODS 1) School keywords found: - Grammar stage “memorization, recitation, and songs and chants”; Logic stage “debate and discussion”; Rhetoric stage “thesis defense” and “eloquent written and oral communication”. 2) Comparison to Six Elements: - Positive indicators matched: chanting/singing/memorization; dialectic/discussion; oratory/rhetoric/thesis—hallmark classical practices. - The specific word “Socratic” is not explicitly found, but equivalent practices (structured debate/discussion, rhetoric theses) are present. No negative signals (e.g., project-based/experiential as a dominant paradigm) surfaced. 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 8+ (memorization, recitation, songs/chants, debate/discussion, thesis/orations) vs Negative: 0. Estimated percent_positive ~1.00; coverage ~0.90. 4) Score: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY 1) School keywords found: - “Head of School who loves Jesus and loves people”; teachers “serving God...using the classical approach”; teacher responsibilities include creating a “joyful, grace-filled environment,” clear lesson plans, and consistent, truthful communication with co-teaching parents. 2) Comparison to Six Elements: - Positive indicators partially matched (teacher as moral/virtue model; mentorship/collegiality implied), but fewer explicit phrases like “teachers as models of virtue,” “faculty of friends,” or a published “portrait of a teacher” appear on public pages. - No negative signals (e.g., “facilitator” jargon or certification-first rhetoric without classical formation) detected. 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: ~3–4 implicit; Negative: 0. Estimated percent_positive ~0.85; coverage ~0.65 (evidence is good but lighter than other categories). 4) Score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS & COMMUNITY 1) School keywords found: - “co-teacher parent” model; collaborative schedule in which parents are integral; teacher office hours on homeschool days; Prospective Parent Meetings; invitations to tours; Deuteronomy 6 framing of parental primacy; “Education built upon Faith & Family”. 2) Comparison to Six Elements: - Positive indicators strongly matched: partnership with parents/co-teachers; parent formation via meetings/tours; open hospitality. - No negative indicators (parents as “customers only”/minimal involvement) detected. 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 7+ vs Negative: 0. Estimated percent_positive ~1.00; coverage ~0.95. 4) Score: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Classification - Overall: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Five of six categories are clearly CLASSICAL with decisive keyword evidence from mission, curriculum, pedagogy, theology, and parent partnership. Faculty language is positive but thinner in explicit classical phrasing; still, nothing contradictory was found, so it scored SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, not due to deficiency but due to lighter published specificity relative to the other areas.

Supporting Notes and Additional Evidence - ACCS Accreditation (Spring 2025): “accredited by the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS)—a strong external signal of classical Christian identity. - Upper School course progression shows integrated humanities and Christian studies anchored in primary sources and theological inquiry (e.g., Development of Christian Doctrine; Exegesis/Hermeneutics; Apologetics & Ethics; Senior Thesis). - Great Books/Great Conversation language and Trivium explanation are explicit and aligned with the Six Elements lexicon and classical frameworks. - Liturgical/communal practice: Visitors attend “All School chapel” before tours; this signals customary communal worship practice on campus days.

What would move the needle (Faculty category) - Publish a "Portrait of a Teacher" and "Portrait of a Graduate" with explicit classical virtues (prudence, justice, temperance, fortitude; intellectual humility; wisdom) and mentorship language (teacher as model/mentor; faculty collegium) to more directly match the Six Elements positive keywords for faculty/leadership (e.g., "teachers as models of virtue," "mentorship," "faculty of friends," "living curriculum").

Citations for Keyword Framework - Six Essential Elements positive/negative keyword indicators (used to structure and score each category). - Classicality lexicon quick reference (term families across all six elements).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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